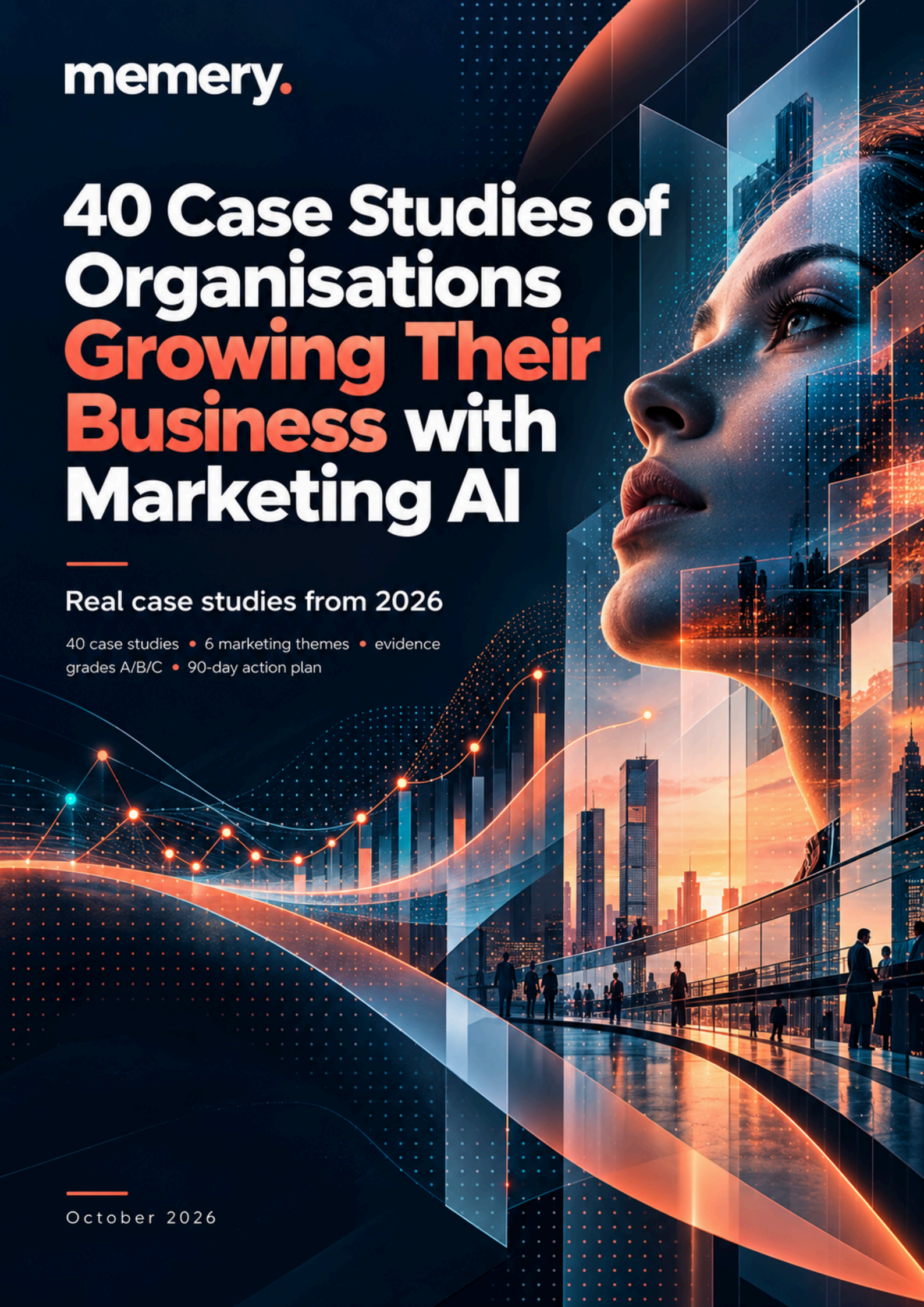


The background of the entire page is a complex digital illustration. On the right side, a woman's profile is shown in a futuristic, glowing blue and orange light. Her face is partially transparent, revealing a city skyline and data points. In the center, a city skyline is visible, with a prominent skyscraper. The foreground features a glowing, wavy line that curves across the page, with data points and a bar chart visible in the background. The overall color scheme is dominated by deep blues, oranges, and whites.

memery.

40 Case Studies of Organisations **Growing Their Business** with Marketing AI

Real case studies from 2026

40 case studies • 6 marketing themes • evidence
grades A/B/C • 90-day action plan

October 2026

This is a field guide, not an AI victory lap.

The useful question in 2026 is no longer “Can AI write an ad?” It can. The useful question is where AI creates a repeatable commercial advantage - faster production, better decisions, stronger customer intelligence, more useful personalisation, a better buying experience or a genuinely lower cost to serve.

This guide combines 40 live examples: 30 from major brands and growth companies, plus 10 from small businesses and solopreneurs. The small-business cases matter because they show what AI looks like without enterprise budgets, custom models or large data teams.

A

Primary / accountable

Company financial disclosure, executive statement or first-party result with accountable ownership. Still self-reported, but higher confidence.

B

Independently reported

Trade press, journalism, analyst research or an independent study. Stronger context, but not always a controlled experiment.

C

Vendor / agency case study

Published by the platform, agency or vendor selling the solution. Useful proof of possibility; treat the numbers as directional.

How to read the numbers

Most results are not independently audited. Savings often exclude build, training and review costs. AI programs are also subject to survivorship bias: companies publish wins more often than failures. Use these examples to choose tests - not to write guaranteed business cases.

AI marketing is splitting into two different games - and both matter.

Large organisations are using AI to industrialise content, decisioning, measurement and commerce. Small businesses are using the same technology differently: as an affordable way to buy capabilities they could never justify hiring full-time.

Enterprise value comes from systems

The strongest large-company results depend on clean product/customer data, governed workflows, decision engines and experimentation - not clever prompts.

Small-business value comes from leverage

For a solo operator, AI can behave like a junior marketer, CRM assistant, copywriter, analyst or developer. The gain is often reclaimed owner time and fewer missed opportunities.

Content is the entry point, not the destination

Production savings are proven, but the more durable advantage is using AI to choose, personalise, measure and act - from next-best conversations to AI-assisted selling.

AI discovery is now a real channel

Brands of every size need evidence that assistants can understand, cite and recommend. For local firms this starts with reviews, service pages, structured data and geographic proof.

The best evidence still comes from testing

Wine Access is especially instructive: three randomised trials compared human, AI and hybrid email workflows using profit, not opinion, as the decision rule.

Human judgement remains the control layer

The pattern is not "replace the marketer". It is automate repetition, widen the option set, and keep accountable humans on objectives, brand, claims and exceptions.

The practical starting point

Pick two measurable bottlenecks: one that saves time or production cost, and one that can create revenue. Baseline them, run controlled pilots for 30–60 days, then keep, kill or scale.

Six things the 40 cases say about AI marketing now

1. Production is the proven win

The clearest, most repeated gains are faster asset creation, localisation and adaptation - but the winners built brand libraries, review gates and data foundations first.

2. AI is becoming a decision engine

The biggest gains often come from thousands of micro-decisions: who gets what message, offer, timing or recommendation - not from shaving minutes off copywriting.

3. Discovery is moving into assistants

Amazon, Walmart, Ramp, Airbyte, Webflow and the small-business GEO cases show that AI answers are becoming a real commercial discovery layer.

4. Measurement matters more as automation rises

Hershey increased measurement cadence; Haus found many brands still did better with manual Meta setups. Automation should make experimentation more rigorous, not less.

5. Trust is a marketing variable

Coca-Cola and Duolingo demonstrate that how AI is used - and how it is described - can affect brand response. Governance protects speed.

6. Small firms use AI as a capability multiplier

Calms Jewelry, Beautiful Digital, MidSouth and others show that the SMB ROI is often an extra "department" without an extra salary.

Australian consumer context

Bench Media research reported in September 2026 found 51% of Australians comfortable with AI models or visuals in ads and 54% trusting generative AI platforms for product research. But three-quarters worried AI-generated models promote unrealistic beauty standards. The practical message: use AI, disclose sensibly, and keep it honest.

Cases 1–14

#	Organisation	What they did	Headline result (as reported)	Ev.
01	Unilever	Digital product twins	Product imagery roughly 2x faster and about 50% cheaper; TRESemmé Thailand reported an 87% fall in content-creation costs and a 5% lift in purchase intent.	A
02	L'Oréal	CreAltech: an internal content engine	CEO disclosure: production costs down 40%; around 50,000 marketing assets created through the system.	A
03	Zalando	AI-generated on-site campaign content	Campaign creation fell from around six weeks to days; output rose about 70% without higher cost; engagement reportedly increased about 10%.	A
04	Mondelez	Generative content at enterprise scale	Executives reported 30–50% lower production costs, with some animation work becoming dramatically cheaper.	A
05	Klarna	AI creative production at industrial scale	Estimated US\$10m annual marketing savings; image-production cycle cut from six weeks to seven days.	B
06	Radisson Hotel Group	Multilingual performance creative	Reported 22% increase in ad-driven revenue, 35% increase in ROAS and 50% improvement in media-team productivity.	C
07	Renner	Controlled test of automated media	Reported 34% lower cost per conversion, 2x revenue and 31% higher ROAS than the incumbent setup.	C
08	Pandora	AI media optimisation with online + offline signals	Reported 7.5% average incremental ROAS uplift; ROAS rose 47% from the first to second half of 2025.	C
09	Cleo	Automation tested with incrementality	Reported 38% lower cost per incremental subscription and materially higher incremental installs, registrations and in-app actions.	C
10	Monks x Hatch	Personalised ad variants by audience	Vendor-reported: 80% higher CTR, 46% more engaged site visitors and 31% better cost per purchase versus other campaigns.	C
11	Sojern	Travel-intent audience prediction	Reported audience-generation time fell from two weeks to under two days; clients reported 20–50% better cost per acquisition.	C
12	Commonwealth Bank	Next-best-conversation engine	CBA says the engine now runs 2,000+ models; earlier disclosures cited 50m next-best conversations and decisions in under 200 milliseconds.	A
13	Kayo Sports	Reinforcement learning for lifecycle decisions	Potential actions expanded from about 300 to 1.2m; reported 14% increase in subscriptions/reactivations and a 105% lift in NBA conversion.	C
14	WHOOOP	Replacing calendar-driven batch email	Reported 10% lift in accessory/shop conversion within six weeks, with projected revenue upside if scaled.	C

Cases 15–27

#	Organisation	What they did	Headline result (as reported)	Ev.
15	Amazon	Rufus shopping assistant	Amazon says Rufus was used by 300m+ customers in 2025 and helped drive nearly US\$12b in incremental annualised sales.	A
16	Walmart	The in-chat checkout lesson	A Walmart executive said in-ChatGPT purchases converted at about one-third the rate of click-outs to Walmart.com.	A
17	Ramp	Content built for AI answers	Vendor-reported AI visibility rose from 3.2% to 22.2% in a month; the new pages earned 300+ citations.	C
18	Airbyte	Systematic AI-search tracking	Vendor-reported ChatGPT visibility rose from 9% to 26% in a week; the company says a US\$100k deal originated in ChatGPT.	C
19	Webflow	Faster content refresh cycles	Reported content-refresh velocity up 5x and a 6% increase in AI-attributed signups within days.	C
20	Verkkokauppa.com	AI-native commerce search	Reported 8% improvement in conversion per visitor and 4% increase in products added to cart.	C
21	Hershey	Monthly AI-run marketing mix modelling	Decisions on media and trade spend can now be made monthly; Hershey has discussed an expected 4–5% revenue lift from media when fully rolled out.	A
22	Colgate-Palmolive	Digital-twin consumers - and a limit	A Colgate analytics leader said promotion ROI was not well suited to AI alone and the working solution remained roughly 80% traditional techniques.	B
23	Haus	640 incrementality tests on Meta automation	58% of brands reportedly achieved higher incremental return with their own campaign setup than with full automation; Meta overall still drove positive lift.	B
24	Microsoft	AI Messaging Assistant grounded in customer evidence	Microsoft estimates about US\$10m in value from extending customer intelligence into marketing workflows.	A
25	Reckitt	From research to ideas faster	Reported at least 60% efficiency improvement in marketing, with AI-assisted ideas testing at comparable levels to traditionally developed ideas.	A
26	Virgin Voyages	"Email Ellie" marketing assistant	Reported about 40% less time spent on campaign copy and 35% lower agency costs.	C
27	Zapier	AI-assisted lead QA and campaign operations	Thousands of leads can be checked each month while the team supports seven-plus enterprise campaigns per quarter.	C

Cases 28–40

#	Organisation	What they did	Headline result (as reported)	Ev.
28	Dept x Blackroll	Agent-built ecommerce redesign	Dept reported the redesign was completed 3.8x faster than its original estimate.	B
29	Macquarie Bank	Enterprise AI + customer self-service	Reported 100,000+ staff hours reclaimed and 38% more users directed to self-service.	C
30	Duolingo	The cost of how you talk about AI	TikTok reportedly lost 400,000+ followers in the following weeks, although Duolingo remained the world's leading language app in 2026.	B
31	Calms Jewelry	AI as a one-person creative department	For one ring ad, an AI-suggested video concept delivered a 291% increase in click-through rate versus her initial creative ideas.	B
32	Beautiful Digital	Reviving forgotten leads with AI-assisted follow-up	Agbi reported a 25% increase in new business from abandoned contacts and dormant client relationships.	B
33	The Original Tamale Co.	A same-day customer-finding tool and faster social content	The market locator went from idea to live website feature in the same afternoon, reducing friction for customers trying to find the business at markets across Los Angeles.	C
34	Wine Access	AI-written email tested with real profit, not vibes	Across all three experiments an AI policy was selected over the human-only policy on annual net profit. In the third experiment, prompt-based AI/hybrid policies beat human by about 8–9% on projected net profit.	B
35	MidSouth Dumpster Rentals	A local-service marketing engine that runs every day	Vendor-reported: indexed pages rose from 8 to 50+, output reached 30+ blog posts a month, owner marketing time fell by 15+ hours a week, and the system paid for itself in under 45 days.	C
36	JaeLuxe Shoetique	An agent doing the jobs a solo retailer cannot staff	Polk said the agent built the influencer campaign from scratch, monitored enquiries, replied to applicants and sent contracts - capabilities normally spread across several roles.	C
37	Mulholland Grocery	Ads in minutes instead of office hours	Mulholland said ad creation that previously took hours can be produced in minutes, freeing time for the product work that directly earns revenue.	C
38	Bikes Online	AI sales assistance inside ecommerce	Vendor-reported across 20,000+ interactions: 8.4% of total revenue assisted by AI, 48% higher AOV on AI-assisted orders and 92.53% of questions answered successfully.	C
39	NextGen Electricians	Designing a local business to be found by AI assistants	Agency-reported: #1 on core local Google searches and an AI-search visibility score of 83/100, with the business named first by Perplexity, Gemini and Claude in testing.	C
40	TACT Bio Recovery	Turning search and AI discovery into a local pipeline	Agency-reported: from near zero to 22 enquiries a month in under eight months; 500+ Google keywords ranking and mentions in ChatGPT and Claude.	C

THEME 01

Build a content engine, not a content queue

The most mature AI marketing use case: making more useful assets, faster and cheaper, inside brand guardrails.

START HERE

Pick one high-volume, low-risk format: social variants, localisation, product pages or EDMs.

BUILD GUARDRAILS

Approved assets, claims, visual rules, human review and a record of what was AI-generated.

MEASURE

Cost and hours per usable asset, time-to-publish and performance versus current content.

WATCH OUT

Headline savings often exclude build, training and review costs. Count them.

Build a content engine, not a content queue

01

Unilever

Digital product twins

A

WHAT THEY DID

Built physically accurate 3D digital twins of product packs so approved imagery can be generated across variants, languages and channels without a fresh shoot.

WHAT HAPPENED

Product imagery roughly 2x faster and about 50% cheaper; TRESemme Thailand reported an 87% fall in content-creation costs and a 5% lift in purchase intent.

COPY THE PLAY

Fix the single source of truth first: product data, pack shots, claims and approved assets. AI production compounds only when the inputs are clean.

SOURCE: Unilever / NVIDIA / trade reporting

02

L'Oréal

CreAltech: an internal content engine

A

WHAT THEY DID

Runs a proprietary generative content platform and has paired it with broad staff training and approved model access.

WHAT HAPPENED

CEO disclosure: production costs down 40%; around 50,000 marketing assets created through the system.

COPY THE PLAY

Platform plus people. Give marketers an approved front door to models, brand assets and review rules, then train widely.

SOURCE: L'Oréal executive disclosures / trade reporting

Build a content engine, not a content queue

03

Zalando

AI-generated on-site campaign content

A

WHAT THEY DID

Uses AI and digital twins to produce a large share of editorial and marketing content for its own app and site, responding quickly to trends.

WHAT HAPPENED

Campaign creation fell from around six weeks to days; output rose about 70% without higher cost; engagement reportedly increased about 10%.

COPY THE PLAY

Speed to relevance can matter more than making "better" content. Use AI where freshness and variation are commercially valuable.

SOURCE: Zalando corporate / trade reporting

04

Mondelez

Generative content at enterprise scale

A

WHAT THEY DID

Built a large-scale content system with Publicis and Accenture for social content, ecommerce pages and animation, with human review and restrictions on synthetic people.

WHAT HAPPENED

Executives reported 30–50% lower production costs, with some animation work becoming dramatically cheaper.

COPY THE PLAY

Start with high-volume, lower-risk formats. Keep humans reviewing claims and cultural nuance; define what the model must never create.

SOURCE: Mondelez executive disclosures / Reuters reporting

Build a content engine, not a content queue

05

Klarna

AI creative production at industrial scale

B

WHAT THEY DID

Moved image production, translation and campaign adaptation into governed generative-AI workflows using tools including Midjourney, DALL-E and Firefly.

WHAT HAPPENED

Estimated US\$10m annual marketing savings; image-production cycle cut from six weeks to seven days.

COPY THE PLAY

Choose one recurring campaign family, baseline cost and turnaround, then compare AI-assisted production against the current route.

SOURCE: Klarna disclosures reported by Reuters

06

Radisson Hotel Group

Multilingual performance creative

C

WHAT THEY DID

Combined customer/property data with AI to generate and translate personalised ad copy across 30+ languages.

WHAT HAPPENED

Reported 22% increase in ad-driven revenue, 35% increase in ROAS and 50% improvement in media-team productivity.

COPY THE PLAY

Localisation is a high-confidence starting point: structured product data + constrained claims + native-language review.

SOURCE: Google Cloud customer story

Personalise performance, not just creative

AI earns its keep when it chooses the right audience, bid, placement, offer or message - and proves incremental lift.

START HERE

Choose one stable product set and compare an AI-optimised campaign with your current setup.

FEED THE MACHINE

Use clean conversion signals and, where relevant, offline outcomes - not just clicks.

MEASURE

Incremental conversions, cost per incremental result, ROAS and creative fatigue.

WATCH OUT

Vendor dashboards can over-credit automation. Use hold-outs or geo tests where possible.

Personalise performance, not just creative

07

Renner

Controlled test of automated media

C

WHAT THEY DID

Brazilian retailer Renner tested TikTok Smart+ against its established prospecting setup during Black Friday.

WHAT HAPPENED

Reported 34% lower cost per conversion, 2x revenue and 31% higher ROAS than the incumbent setup.

COPY THE PLAY

Copy the test design, not the platform. Hold period and creative pool steady and compare directly with your current best practice.

SOURCE: TikTok for Business case study

08

Pandora

AI media optimisation with online + offline signals

C

WHAT THEY DID

Used Pinterest Performance+ for targeting, bidding and creative adaptation while feeding online and offline conversion data back into the system.

WHAT HAPPENED

Reported 7.5% average incremental ROAS uplift; ROAS rose 47% from the first to second half of 2025.

COPY THE PLAY

If stores matter, train the system on store outcomes too. Optimise against the real commercial result, not an easy digital proxy.

SOURCE: Pinterest business case study

Personalise performance, not just creative

09

Cleo

Automation tested with incrementality

C

WHAT THEY DID

Financial app Cleo tested TikTok Smart+ against its business-as-usual value-based optimisation strategy and used a conversion-lift study.

WHAT HAPPENED

Reported 38% lower cost per incremental subscription and materially higher incremental installs, registrations and in-app actions.

COPY THE PLAY

Ask for incrementality, not only platform-attributed conversions. A control or hold-out is the difference between learning and wishful thinking.

SOURCE: TikTok for Business case study

10

Monks x Hatch

Personalised ad variants by audience

C

WHAT THEY DID

Monks used Gemini to build personalised campaign variants for Hatch.

WHAT HAPPENED

Vendor-reported: 80% higher CTR, 46% more engaged site visitors and 31% better cost per purchase versus other campaigns.

COPY THE PLAY

Segment before you generate. Create genuinely different propositions for three to five audiences, then compare against a control.

SOURCE: Google Cloud customer story

Personalise performance, not just creative

11

Sojern



Travel-intent audience prediction

WHAT THEY DID

Processes large volumes of traveller-intent signals into daily audience predictions for tourism advertisers.

WHAT HAPPENED

Reported audience-generation time fell from two weeks to under two days; clients reported 20–50% better cost per acquisition.

COPY THE PLAY

Predictive targeting is only as good as intent data. Ask vendors for hold-out evidence and understand where the signal comes from.

SOURCE: Google Cloud customer story

Move from segments to next-best decisions

The strongest personalisation systems decide what should happen next for an individual - message, offer, timing or service.

START HERE

Map five customer moments where a useful next action matters: renewal, churn, purchase, service or reactivation.

DESIGN DECISIONS

Define the action set, constraints and customer value - not just the message copy.

MEASURE

Incremental conversion, retention, customer outcome and opt-out rate.

WATCH OUT

A personalised system can optimise the wrong objective very efficiently. Human objectives come first.

Move from segments to next-best decisions

12

Commonwealth Bank

Next-best-conversation engine

A

WHAT THEY DID

Uses a decisioning platform across app, branch and call centre to select the next best conversation for each customer, including useful nudges such as Benefits Finder.

WHAT HAPPENED

CBA says the engine now runs 2,000+ models; earlier disclosures cited 50m next-best conversations and decisions in under 200 milliseconds.

COPY THE PLAY

Personalisation at scale is infrastructure, not a chatbot. Start with a handful of high-value customer moments and a clean decision logic.

SOURCE: CBA shareholder letter / Pega / iTnews

13

Kayo Sports

Reinforcement learning for lifecycle decisions

C

WHAT THEY DID

Built a "Customer Cortex" using reinforcement-learning models and AI decisioning to expand the number of actions available for subscribers.

WHAT HAPPENED

Potential actions expanded from about 300 to 1.2m; reported 14% increase in subscriptions/reactivations and a 105% lift in NBA conversion.

COPY THE PLAY

Stop asking "which journey?" and ask "what action is most useful for this person now?" Start with one lifecycle moment and a small action set.

SOURCE: Braze customer story

Move from segments to next-best decisions

14

WHOOOP

Replacing calendar-driven batch email

C

WHAT THEY DID

Connected AI decisioning to behavioural and commerce signals to choose messages and timing rather than sending fixed batch campaigns.

WHAT HAPPENED

Reported 10% lift in accessory/shop conversion within six weeks, with projected revenue upside if scaled.

COPY THE PLAY

Pick a category with frequent behavioural signals and enough volume to learn. Keep a hold-out so you know whether the decisioning adds value.

SOURCE: Vendor/customer case study

15

Amazon

Rufus shopping assistant

A

WHAT THEY DID

Embedded an AI shopping assistant into the Amazon app/site to answer product questions, compare options and recommend what to buy.

WHAT HAPPENED

Amazon says Rufus was used by 300m+ customers in 2025 and helped drive nearly US\$12b in incremental annualised sales.

COPY THE PLAY

Make your product data, reviews, comparisons and Q&A rich enough for an assistant to recommend you. Conversation is becoming a buying interface.

SOURCE: Amazon earnings / Modern Retail

Move from segments to next-best decisions

16

Walmart

The in-chat checkout lesson

A

WHAT THEY DID

Tested direct purchase inside ChatGPT, then shifted toward embedding its own assistant while keeping login, cart and checkout on Walmart systems.

WHAT HAPPENED

A Walmart executive said in-ChatGPT purchases converted at about one-third the rate of click-outs to Walmart.com.

COPY THE PLAY

Be discoverable on AI platforms, but test carefully before giving away the transaction. Own the customer relationship where it matters.

SOURCE: Walmart executive / Axios reporting

THEME 04

Win the new discovery layer

Buyers increasingly ask AI assistants what to buy. AI visibility is becoming a measurable marketing channel alongside search.

START HERE

List 50–100 questions buyers ask and track whether your brand is mentioned and cited across major AI assistants.

PUBLISH BETTER ANSWERS

Comparisons, pricing explainers, how-to-choose guides, original data and expert input.

MEASURE

Share of answers, citations, AI referrals, leads and revenue sourced from AI discovery.

WATCH OUT

AI visibility metrics are young and answers vary run-to-run. Treat scores as directional.

Win the new discovery layer

17

Ramp

Content built for AI answers

C

WHAT THEY DID

Tracked visibility in AI answers for accounts-payable topics, then created focused pages around automation and software comparisons.

WHAT HAPPENED

Vendor-reported AI visibility rose from 3.2% to 22.2% in a month; the new pages earned 300+ citations.

COPY THE PLAY

Find the questions buyers actually ask and publish the clearest, most comparative answer. Original data and specificity beat generic SEO copy.

SOURCE: Profound case study

18

Airbyte

Systematic AI-search tracking

C

WHAT THEY DID

Tracked hundreds of prompts across ChatGPT, Perplexity, Google AI features and Copilot, segmented by topic and country, then prioritised content updates.

WHAT HAPPENED

Vendor-reported ChatGPT visibility rose from 9% to 26% in a week; the company says a US\$100k deal originated in ChatGPT.

COPY THE PLAY

Treat AI visibility like brand tracking: a fixed prompt set, measured regularly, tied to referral traffic and pipeline.

SOURCE: Profound case study / Adweek

Win the new discovery layer

19 Webflow

Faster content refresh cycles

WHAT THEY DID

Worked with an AI content platform to speed the rate at which high-value content is refreshed and restructured.

WHAT HAPPENED

Reported content-refresh velocity up 5x and a 6% increase in AI-attributed signups within days.

COPY THE PLAY

Refresh pages that answer buying questions and earn mentions beyond your own site: reviews, press, partners and communities.

SOURCE: AirOps 2026 AI Search Playbook

20 Verkkokauppa.com

AI-native commerce search

WHAT THEY DID

Finnish retailer implemented AI search for commerce to better understand natural-language product intent and surface relevant results.

WHAT HAPPENED

Reported 8% improvement in conversion per visitor and 4% increase in products added to cart.

COPY THE PLAY

Your own search box is part of the AI experience. Test natural-language search on complex categories where customers struggle to filter.

SOURCE: Google Cloud customer story

THEME 05

Turn measurement and insight into an always-on capability

AI is changing how quickly marketers learn - but the strongest examples also show where traditional methods still win.

START HERE

Clean one source of truth for spend, sales and customer evidence before adding new models.

INCREASE CADENCE

Make a trusted measurement or insight process faster before inventing a new black box.

MEASURE

Time from question to answer, decisions changed, incremental lift and agreement with real customer evidence.

WATCH OUT

Synthetic audiences are screening tools, not substitutes for real people on high-stakes decisions.

Turn measurement and insight into an always-on capability

21

Hershey

Monthly AI-run marketing mix modelling

A

WHAT THEY DID

Moved from a few MMM cycles a year to monthly modelling across the portfolio using AI agents and improved data pipelines.

WHAT HAPPENED

Decisions on media and trade spend can now be made monthly; Hershey has discussed an expected 4–5% revenue lift from media when fully rolled out.

COPY THE PLAY

Increase the cadence of a measurement discipline you already trust. The data foundation is the investment; the AI is the accelerator.

SOURCE: Hershey / Adweek / B&T

22

Colgate-Palmolive

Digital-twin consumers - and a limit

B

WHAT THEY DID

Uses simulated consumers and generative tools over proprietary research to test claims and ideas, while also experimenting with AI in promotion measurement.

WHAT HAPPENED

A Colgate analytics leader said promotion ROI was not well suited to AI alone and the working solution remained roughly 80% traditional techniques.

COPY THE PLAY

Use AI where data is rich and questions repeat. Keep proven methods where they outperform. Scepticism is part of the operating model.

SOURCE: Reuters NEXT / WARC reporting

Turn measurement and insight into an always-on capability

23

Haus

640 incrementality tests on Meta automation

B

WHAT THEY DID

Analysed hundreds of geo hold-out incrementality tests across brands using Meta, including automated Advantage+ approaches.

WHAT HAPPENED

58% of brands reportedly achieved higher incremental return with their own campaign setup than with full automation; Meta overall still drove positive lift.

COPY THE PLAY

Black boxes optimise what they can see. Measure incremental outcomes, not platform-reported attribution, before handing over more control.

SOURCE: Haus analysis reported by MediaCat

24

Microsoft

AI Messaging Assistant grounded in customer evidence

A

WHAT THEY DID

Built an internal assistant grounded in 100,000+ customer interviews and research artefacts so teams can create messaging from evidence rather than intuition.

WHAT HAPPENED

Microsoft estimates about US\$10m in value from extending customer intelligence into marketing workflows.

COPY THE PLAY

Ground generative AI in proprietary customer evidence. The differentiator is not the model; it is the context no competitor has.

SOURCE: Microsoft customer/marketing disclosures

Turn measurement and insight into an always-on capability

25

Reckitt



From research to ideas faster

WHAT THEY DID

Combined generative AI, internal data and analytics to create an insights generator that helps marketing teams move from question to idea more quickly.

WHAT HAPPENED

Reported at least 60% efficiency improvement in marketing, with AI-assisted ideas testing at comparable levels to traditionally developed ideas.

COPY THE PLAY

Create a weekly insight loop from reviews, search, support, social and research. Use AI to compress synthesis, not to invent the evidence.

SOURCE: Microsoft / Reckitt case study

Build agents around workflows - and keep trust human

The frontier is not a clever chatbot. It is a team of specialised AI workflows connected to real systems, clear approvals and accountable humans.

START HERE

Choose a repeatable workflow with a clear owner and observable inputs/outputs.

WRITE THE CHECKPOINTS

What can run automatically? What needs human approval? What must never be automated?

MEASURE

Revenue, lead quality, cycle time, rework, incidents and customer/staff sentiment - not hours saved alone.

WATCH OUT

How you talk about AI internally will become external. Avoid "replace people" theatre.

Build agents around workflows - and keep trust human

26

Virgin Voyages

"Email Ellie" marketing assistant

C

WHAT THEY DID

Built an AI assistant trained on Virgin Voyages brand context to help marketers draft and adapt campaign copy while preserving the brand voice.

WHAT HAPPENED

Reported about 40% less time spent on campaign copy and 35% lower agency costs.

COPY THE PLAY

Agentise a repeatable workflow with a clear owner: brief, draft, QA, adapt, approve. Do not try to "automate marketing" in one leap.

SOURCE: OpenAI customer story

27

Zapier

AI-assisted lead QA and campaign operations

C

WHAT THEY DID

Enterprise marketing uses AI to quality-check thousands of leads, find research quickly and support campaign workflows across a small team.

WHAT HAPPENED

Thousands of leads can be checked each month while the team supports seven-plus enterprise campaigns per quarter.

COPY THE PLAY

Use agents for repetitive judgement with explicit rules. Save human time for exceptions, relationships and decisions that need context.

SOURCE: OpenAI customer story

Build agents around workflows - and keep trust human

28

Dept x Blackroll

Agent-built ecommerce redesign

B

WHAT THEY DID

Agency Dept used AI agents to accelerate redesign and development of Blackroll's ecommerce platform and now uses agents in ongoing feature testing.

WHAT HAPPENED

Dept reported the redesign was completed 3.8x faster than its original estimate.

COPY THE PLAY

Agents are moving beyond content into testing, site changes and commercial operations. Start where the workflow is repeatable and observable.

SOURCE: Digiday / Dept reporting

29

Macquarie Bank

Enterprise AI + customer self-service

C

WHAT THEY DID

Rolled out enterprise AI tools across staff and used AI-assisted search in customer help experiences.

WHAT HAPPENED

Reported 100,000+ staff hours reclaimed and 38% more users directed to self-service.

COPY THE PLAY

Hours saved are not value until reinvested. Track what teams do with reclaimed capacity and whether customer outcomes improve.

SOURCE: Google Cloud customer story

Build agents around workflows - and keep trust human

30

Duolingo

The cost of how you talk about AI

B

WHAT THEY DID

An “AI-first” internal memo framed automation partly around reducing contractor work, triggering public backlash and a period of brand criticism.

WHAT HAPPENED

TikTok reportedly lost 400,000+ followers in the following weeks, although Duolingo remained the world’s leading language app in 2026.

COPY THE PLAY

How you describe AI becomes marketing. Frame it around better service, better work and better outcomes - not headcount theatre.

SOURCE: 2026 retrospective / trade reporting

Small business: buy capability, not complexity

Ten smaller businesses and solopreneurs show the other side of AI marketing in 2026: simple tools, short feedback loops and owner-level commercial outcomes.

START HERE

Write down the three marketing jobs the owner or tiny team keeps postponing: follow-up, content, customer questions, ads or website updates.

BUY CAPABILITY

Use existing tools before custom builds. Small-business advantage comes from speed of adoption and short feedback loops.

MEASURE

Owner hours reclaimed, dormant leads reactivated, assisted revenue, enquiry volume and cost per useful output.

WATCH OUT

Cheap automation can create expensive brand damage. Keep human approval on outbound messages, claims, pricing and customer exceptions.

Small business: buy capability, not complexity

31

Calms Jewelry

AI as a one-person creative department

B

WHAT THEY DID

Founder Jennifer O'Brien uses ChatGPT and Claude to generate email subject-line variants, campaign ideas and social creative options, then edits them back to her brand voice.

WHAT HAPPENED

For one ring ad, an AI-suggested video concept delivered a 291% increase in click-through rate versus her initial creative ideas.

COPY THE PLAY

Use AI to widen the option set, not outsource taste. Ask for 10 variants, pick two worth testing, then measure them against your own best idea.

SOURCE: Business Insider, 11 May 2026

32

Beautifuli Digital

Reviving forgotten leads with AI-assisted follow-up

B

WHAT THEY DID

Founder Liane Agbi uses HoneyBook AI and Claude to personalise follow-ups based on previous client conversations and to diagnose why promising leads went quiet.

WHAT HAPPENED

Agbi reported a 25% increase in new business from abandoned contacts and dormant client relationships.

COPY THE PLAY

Before buying more leads, mine the ones you already paid for. Give AI the history, your tone and a clear next action, then keep a human review before send.

SOURCE: Business Insider, 11 May 2026

Small business: buy capability, not complexity

33 The Original Tamale Co.

A same-day customer-finding tool and faster social content

C

WHAT THEY DID

Christian Ortega used ChatGPT to code a searchable farmers-market locator for the family business website despite having no coding experience; the team also uses it to support social content.

WHAT HAPPENED

The market locator went from idea to live website feature in the same afternoon, reducing friction for customers trying to find the business at markets across Los Angeles.

COPY THE PLAY

Turn recurring customer questions into useful tools. Small firms can now test a simple digital utility without waiting for a developer backlog.

SOURCE: OpenAI small-business customer story, 4 Feb 2026

34 Wine Access

AI-written email tested with real profit, not vibes

B

WHAT THEY DID

A small online wine retailer ran three randomised controlled trials comparing salaried writers, LLM-written newsletters and human-edited AI copy.

WHAT HAPPENED

Across all three experiments an AI policy was selected over the human-only policy on annual net profit. In the third experiment, prompt-based AI/hybrid policies beat human by about 8–9% on projected net profit.

COPY THE PLAY

Test AI copy on real customers, include labour and software cost, and choose the workflow that maximises profit rather than content volume.

SOURCE: Dubé & Xu, Quantitative Marketing and Economics, 2026

Small business: buy capability, not complexity

35 MidSouth Dumpster Rentals

A local-service marketing engine that runs every day

C

WHAT THEY DID

The Mississippi dumpster business automated daily SEO articles, keyword discovery and social posting through an AI workflow rather than hiring a marketing team.

WHAT HAPPENED

Vendor-reported: indexed pages rose from 8 to 50+, output reached 30+ blog posts a month, owner marketing time fell by 15+ hours a week, and the system paid for itself in under 45 days.

COPY THE PLAY

For local businesses, consistency can be the moat. Automate repetitive production, but keep a weekly human check on accuracy, duplication and local usefulness.

SOURCE: iRabbit Automation case study, 20 Feb 2026

36 JaeLuxe Shoetique

An agent doing the jobs a solo retailer cannot staff

C

WHAT THEY DID

Founder April Polk uses Meta Muse across brand guidelines, website updates, email flows, performance analysis and a user-generated-content influencer program.

WHAT HAPPENED

Polk said the agent built the influencer campaign from scratch, monitored enquiries, replied to applicants and sent contracts - capabilities normally spread across several roles.

COPY THE PLAY

Connect an agent to one bounded growth workflow first, such as influencer recruitment. Require approval before external action and expand only when the workflow is stable.

SOURCE: Meta / Yahoo Tech reporting, Sept 2026

Small business: buy capability, not complexity

37

Mulholland Grocery

Ads in minutes instead of office hours

C

WHAT THEY DID

Owner Tom Mulholland uses Meta Muse to create advertising from products he plans to stock, alongside scheduling and other office work.

WHAT HAPPENED

Mulholland said ad creation that previously took hours can be produced in minutes, freeing time for the product work that directly earns revenue.

COPY THE PLAY

The small-business business case is often owner time, not headcount. Automate work that pulls the owner away from the thing customers actually pay for.

SOURCE: Meta Muse for Small Business reporting, Sept 2026

38

Bikes Online

AI sales assistance inside ecommerce

C

WHAT THEY DID

The ecommerce retailer uses an AI sales agent connected to Shopify and its product knowledge to answer questions and guide shoppers to relevant products.

WHAT HAPPENED

Vendor-reported across 20,000+ interactions: 8.4% of total revenue assisted by AI, 48% higher AOV on AI-assisted orders and 92.53% of questions answered successfully.

COPY THE PLAY

A chatbot becomes marketing when it helps customers choose. Ground it in approved product data, track assisted revenue and escalate anything uncertain to a person.

SOURCE: REP AI customer case study, 25 June 2026

Small business: buy capability, not complexity

39

NextGen Electricians

Designing a local business to be found by AI assistants

C

WHAT THEY DID

The Victorian electrical business rebuilt its web presence with schema-rich, AI-search-ready service and location content designed for both search engines and answer engines.

WHAT HAPPENED

Agency-reported: #1 on core local Google searches and an AI-search visibility score of 83/100, with the business named first by Perplexity, Gemini and Claude in testing.

COPY THE PLAY

For local firms, GEO starts with basics: specific service pages, geographic proof, strong reviews, structured data and clear evidence of why you are credible.

SOURCE: Dossis Digital case study, 2026

40

TACT Bio Recovery

Turning search and AI discovery into a local pipeline

C

WHAT THEY DID

The specialist Melbourne cleaning business combined local SEO, tightly targeted paid search and content structured to surface in AI-assisted discovery.

WHAT HAPPENED

Agency-reported: from near zero to 22 enquiries a month in under eight months; 500+ Google keywords ranking and mentions in ChatGPT and Claude.

COPY THE PLAY

Do not treat AI visibility as a vanity metric. Tie it to enquiries: measure where prospects found you, which queries trigger recommendations and what converts.

SOURCE: Dossis Digital case study, 2026

Eight patterns across all 40

1. Start with a bottleneck, not a tool

The best cases began with a measurable pain: production cycles, weak discovery, slow insight, churn, missed leads or media inefficiency.

2. Build guardrails into the system

Approved data, brand rules, human review and explicit exclusions are what let teams scale safely.

3. Proprietary context is the moat

Customer evidence, product data, first-party behaviour and brand knowledge make generic models commercially useful.

4. Test against reality

Use controls, hold-outs, real panels and incremental measurement. Confident AI output is not evidence.

5. Keep the customer relationship

Be present in assistants, but think carefully before outsourcing checkout, identity or service ownership.

6. Humans keep judgement calls

AI can generate and optimise. Humans still set objectives, interpret ambiguity and own reputational risk.

7. Trust compounds too

The fastest AI system in the world is useless if customers or staff stop trusting the brand.

8. Small firms buy capability, not transformation

The small-business cases show a different ROI logic: reclaim owner time, recover missed leads and create capabilities that previously required another hire or agency.

Choose use cases by complexity and proof

LOW COMPLEXITY · FAST PROOF

Best for: learning and immediate efficiency.

Localisation
Content adaptation
Research synthesis
Dormant-lead follow-up
Creative variants
Local AI-search basics

Goal: prove time, lead or cycle improvement without weakening quality.

MEDIUM COMPLEXITY · DIRECT REVENUE

Best for: performance, ecommerce and lifecycle teams.

Media optimisation
Next-best messaging
Product recommendations
AI search visibility
Triggered journeys
AI sales assistance

Goal: prove incremental conversion, revenue or retention.

HIGHER COMPLEXITY · COMPOUNDING ADVANTAGE

Best for: organisations with clean data and mature governance.

Decision engines
Marketing agents
AI-native commerce
Always-on MMM
Enterprise content systems

Goal: build a capability competitors cannot copy with a subscription.

Six layers that turn AI from a tool into a marketing system

Most AI pilots fail in the gaps between the model and the organisation. Build these six layers explicitly.

1. OBJECTIVE

The commercial result the system is allowed to optimise.

2. CONTEXT

Brand rules, product data, customer evidence, first-party signals.

3. DECISIONS

What choices can AI make or recommend?

4. EXECUTION

Content, media, journeys, site changes, service or sales actions.

5. EVALUATION

Controls, hold-outs, quality checks and customer outcomes.

6. HUMAN CONTROL

Named owners, approval gates, exclusions and escalation.

A useful test

Remove the model name from your business case. If the proposal still explains the objective, context, decision, workflow, measurement and human ownership, you probably have a real use case. If it collapses into “we will use AI”, you do not.

What this evidence cannot tell you

Survivorship bias

Organisations publish wins. Failed pilots, stalled integrations and hidden costs are under-represented.

Self-reporting

Many figures come from the organisation or its vendor. Evidence grades tell you how much external accountability sits behind a claim.

Scale

Enterprise examples can overstate the resources required; SMB examples can understate governance. Adapt the logic, not the cost base.

Build costs

Headline savings often exclude integration, data cleaning, training, review and change management.

Correlation

Customers who choose an AI feature may already be more valuable. Correlation is not causation.

Short windows

Many published results span weeks or months. Durability and novelty effects remain uncertain.

Model drift

The tools and underlying models change quickly. Re-test workflows that depend on a specific model behaviour.

Human acceptance

Staff and customer trust can become the binding constraint even when the technology works.

The decision rule

Use case studies to form hypotheses. Use your own controlled tests to make investment decisions.

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Method note

"2026" means reported, operating or commercially relevant in 2026. Some programs began earlier and were still scaling in 2026. Figures are reproduced as reported by the named organisations and publications and have not been independently audited by Memery unless the source itself is an independent study. Evidence grades indicate the level of accountability behind each case.

Where could AI make your marketing easier to notice, remember and choose?

Memery AI Marketing Opportunity Workshop

Memery helps organisations move beyond scattered AI experiments to a practical operating model. We identify the highest-value use cases, define what stays human, set the guardrails and turn the best opportunities into an implementation plan your team can actually use.

The output: a prioritised use-case shortlist, success measures, workflow design, governance checkpoints and a practical pilot plan.

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About memery

Strategy, segmentation, AI, storytelling and content for mission-driven organisations doing something worth remembering.

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